

Annie and the Lanterns of the Wild West

Cowboy story • 3-4 years old



Part One: Setting Off

Once upon a time, in the sunny Wild West, there was a brave cowgirl named Annie. Annie wore a big, brown hat and shiny boots. She loved riding her horse, Daisy, across the wide-open plains. One day, the Sheriff came to Annie. « **Annie,** » he said, « **we need lanterns on the path to guide travelers safely at night. Can you help?** »

Annie nodded. « **Of course, Sheriff! Daisy and I can do it!** » So, Annie packed a bag with shiny lanterns and set off with Daisy. The sun was shining, and the wind was gentle. Annie felt excited.

Part Two: The Great Adventure

As Annie and Daisy trotted along, they met a friendly rabbit named Benny. « **Hello, Annie!** » squeaked Benny. « **What are you doing today?** »

Annie smiled. « **We're putting up lanterns on the path. Would you like to help?** »

Benny nodded happily. « **Yes, please!** » So, Benny hopped along with them. Together, they hung the lanterns on the tall poles. Benny held the poles steady while Annie climbed up.

Soon, they reached a wide river. « **Oh no!** » said Annie. « **How will we cross?** »

Benny wiggled his nose. « **Let's build a bridge with those logs!** » he said. Annie, Daisy, and Benny worked together, pushing logs into place. Soon, they had a wobbly bridge. One by one, they crossed safely. « **Hooray!** » cheered Annie.

Part Three: Lighting the Way

As the sun began to set, Annie, Daisy, and Benny reached the last part of the path. « **This is the most important spot,** » said Annie, « **because it's the darkest.** »

They carefully placed the last lantern. Annie struck a match and lit the lanterns, one by one. The path glowed with a warm, golden light. « **It's beautiful!** » said Benny.

Annie smiled. « **Now, everyone can travel safely at night,** » she said. They watched as the stars began to twinkle above.

« **Thank you, Annie,** » said Benny. « **You are very brave and smart.** »

Annie hugged Benny. « **And thank you for helping us,** » she said. Daisy neighed happily, and they all laughed.

As they headed back home, Annie felt proud. She knew she had done something good. The lanterns flickered brightly, lighting the way for friends and travelers in the Wild West. And as they rode home, the night was calm and safe, and all was well.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) Who is the brave cowgirl in the story?

- Annie
- Benny
- Daisy
- Sheriff

2) What is the name of Annie's horse?

- Daisy
- Benny
- Lantern
- Sheriff

3) Who is the friendly rabbit that helps Annie?

- Benny
- Daisy
- Sheriff
- Annie

4) What do Annie and her friends put up to help travelers at night?

- Lanterns
- Tents
- Balloons
- Signs

Correct answers:

1) Annie 2) Daisy 3) Benny 4) Lanterns

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Lanterns: Small lights that people carry to see in the dark.

Travelers: People who go from one place to another.

Trotted: A medium-speed run that a horse makes, not too fast.

Poles: Long, thin sticks used to hold things up.

Climbed: Went up something, like a ladder or a pole.

River: A long flow of water that moves across the land.

Bridge: Something built over water so people can cross safely.

Logs: Thick pieces of tree that are cut down.

Wobbly: Not steady, can move from side to side.

Sunset: When the sun goes down and the sky gets darker.

Twinkle: To shine with small, quick flashes of light.

Struck a match: To make a small stick burn to make a tiny light.

Lit: Made something start to burn or shine with light.

Path: A small road or way where people can walk.